

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION COUNSELOR EXAMINERS AND THE STATE  
BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2023-4824 & 2023-4825

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**STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER**

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IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE  
ADDICTION COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO AND THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE  
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF LAURA WHITCOMB,  
LICENSE NOS. ACD 1527, LPC 15259,

Respondent.

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IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Addiction  
Counselor Examiners and the State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor  
Examiners (together, “Boards”) and Laura Whitcomb (“Respondent”), as follows:

1. The Boards have jurisdiction over the person of Respondent and the  
subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order (“Order”).

2. Respondent was licensed to practice as an addiction counselor (“LAC”) in  
the State of Colorado on August 14, 2020, having been issued license number ACD  
1527, and is currently so licensed. Respondent was licensed to practice as a  
professional counselor (“LPC”) in the State of Colorado on February 27, 2019, having  
been issued license number LPC 15259, and is currently so licensed.

3. This Order is a full and final resolution of case numbers 2023-4824 and  
2023-4825. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters,  
known or unknown to the Boards or Respondent, as of the effective date of this  
Order.

4. Respondent admits the following:

a. On or about February 14, 2024, Respondent underwent a mental  
status examination with Peer Assistance Services, Inc. (“PAS”). The evaluator  
concluded that Respondent is only safe to practice as an ACD/LPC with  
reasonable skill and safety, with treatment and monitoring.

b. Respondent failed to notify the Boards of a behavioral, mental  
health, or substance use disorder that affects her ability to treat clients with  
reasonable skill and safety.

c. Respondent failed to act within the limitations created by a behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that renders her unable to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under her care.

d. Respondent relocated outside of Colorado and is unable to participate in PAS.

5. By virtue of the admissions in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Boards find that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(f)(I) and (II), C.R.S., which states:

**12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions.** (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(f)(I) Fails to notify the board that regulates the person's profession of a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that affects the person's ability to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under his or her care; (II) Fails to act within the limitations created by a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that renders the person unable to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under his or her care.

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Boards believe are necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

### **RELINQUISHMENT**

7. Respondent hereby relinquishes her LAC and LPC licenses in the State of Colorado, commencing from the effective date of this Order, and requests that the Boards accept said relinquishments. Such relinquishments shall have the same force and effect as revocations ordered by the Boards, including the provisions of section 12-20-404(3), C.R.S.

8. Following relinquishment of her licenses, Respondent shall not perform any act requiring a license practice in Colorado.

9. Respondent understands that if she applies for licensure or certification as a LAC or LPC at any future time, Respondent will be required to comply with all criteria for the initial licensure that exist at the time of application.

10. Respondent also agrees not to perform any act constituting psychotherapy

as defined under section 12-245-202(14), C.R.S.

### **TERMS AND CONDITIONS**

11. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

12. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

13. This Order shall become an order of the Boards when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representatives.

14. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403, 12-245-214, 12-245-226, and 24-4-104(9), C.R.S.

15. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

16. Respondent shall obey all state and federal laws while this Order is in effect.

17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Boards. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

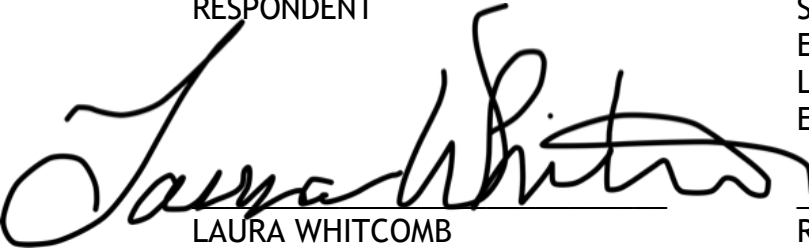
18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Boards, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Boards. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Boards.

19. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Boards.

20. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Boards.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT

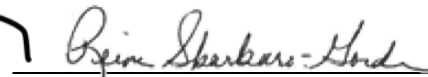


LAURA WHITCOMB

LICENSE Nos. ACD 1527, LPC 15259

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION COUNSELOR  
EXAMINERS AND THE STATE BOARD OF  
LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR  
EXAMINERS



REINA SBARBARO-GORDON

Program Director

Effective this 9th day of October,  
2024.